



February
21

1858

Alarm raised

US inventor Edwin Holmes installed the first electric burglar alarm in a home in Boston, USA. Within a few years, he'd sold more than 1,200 alarms to safety-conscious customers, thwarting would-be burglars.



1804 First steam locomotive

British engineer Richard Trevithick's steam-powered railway locomotive made its first journey. In just over four hours, the steam engine hauled five wagons, 10 tonnes of iron, and 70 people almost 16 km (10 miles).

Born this day

1933 Nina Simone, Black American singer and songwriter. She was a campaigner for racial justice.

Also on this day

1848 German thinkers **Karl Marx** and **Friedrich Engels** published their influential political ideas in *The Communist Manifesto*.

1974 **Josip Broz Tito** was declared **Yugoslavia's "president for life"** by the country's new constitution.

1995 US adventurer **Steve Fossett** landed in **Canada** after four days of flying solo across the Pacific Ocean in a hot-air balloon.

1965

Malcolm X shot

Malcolm X, a Black American Muslim activist, was killed in New York City. He had fought for racial justice for Black Americans.

